The above features are the distinct characteristic of which one of the following regions?

(a) Mediterranean
(b) Eastern China
(c) Central Asia
(d) Atlantic coast of North America

Ans. (a) : Mediterranean climatic type is associated with all of the above features. The climate is known for warm to hot, dry summers and mild to cool, wet winters. The cause of this climate is directly related to large bodies of water such as Mediterranean sea and ocean currents. Almost no rainfall during the summer. Most of the rainfalls during the cooler winter.

30. What causes wind to deflect toward left in the Southern hemisphere?

(a) temperature (b) Magnetic field
(c) Rotation of the earth (d) Pressure

Ans. (c) : Deflection of wind towards left in Southern Hemisphere (SH) and right in North Hemisphere (NH) is mainly due to rotation of Earth (coriolis force) and Ferrel's Law talks about the diversion i.e., left and right in South and North hemisphere respectively.

31. If there were no Himalayan ranges, what would have been the most likely geographical impact on India?

1. **Much of the country would experience the cold waves from Siberia.**
2. **Indo-genetic plain would be devoid of such extensive alluvial soils.**
3. **The pattern of monsoon would be different from what it is at present.**

Which of the statements given above is/are correct?

(a) 1 only (b) 1 and 3 only
(c) 2 and 3 only (d) 1, 2 and 3

Ans. (d) : All three statements mentioned above are correct. The Himalayas are the tallest mountain ranges of the world and stand as unsurmountable wall. They save us from the severe cold winds which would have entered India in the absence of these mountain ranges. Different places in the Himalayas are the sources of great rivers like the Indus, the Ganga and the Brahmaputra as well as their tributaries. These mighty rivers and their tributaries bring huge quantities of fertile alluvial soils from the mountain areas and deposit these soils in the Indo Gangetic plain. At present this is considered to be one of the most fertile plains of the world. Had there been no Himalayas, the entire plain would be devoid of alluvial soils and it would be totally a barren plain. The Himalayas offer great obstruction to the monsoon winds coming from the Bay of Bengal. These winds cannot cross the Himalayan wall and are forced to move from east to west along the foothills of the Himalayas and cause rains in the entire Indus-Ganga-Brahmaputra plain, in addition to the mountain areas.

32. In India, which type of forest among the following occupies that largest area?

(a) Montane Wet Temperate Forest
(b) Sub-tropical Dry Evergreen Forest
(c) Tropical Moist Deciduous Forest
(d) Tropical Wet Evergreen Forest

Ans. (c) : In India, Tropical Moist Deciduous Forest occupies the largest area. The tropical monsoon deciduous forests are found in areas receiving annual rainfall of 100 to 200 cm in India, with a distinct dry and rainy seasons and a small range of temperature.

33. Consider the following statements:

1. **On the planet Earth, the fresh water available for use amounts to about less than 1% of the total water found.**
2. **Of the total fresh water found on the planet Earth 95% is bound up in polar ice caps and glaciers.**

Which of the statements given above is/are correct?

(a) 1 only (b) 2 only
(c) Both 1 and 2 (d) Neither 1 and 2

Ans. (c) : About 2.75 percent of water is fresh water in earth and about 95% is frozen in glaciers. Less than 1% of the world's fresh water is readily accessible.

34. Following are the characteristics of an area in India:

1. **Hot and humid climate**
2. **Annual rainfall 200 cm**
3. **Hill slopes up to an altitude of 1100 metres**
4. **Annual range of temperature 15°C to 30°C**

Which one among the following crops are you most likely to find in the area described above?

(a) Mustard (b) Cotton
(c) Pepper (d) Virginia tobacco

Ans. (c) : Pepper is the crop most likely to find in the area described above.

35. A geographic area with an altitude of 400 metres has following characteristics:

Month	J	F	M	A	M	J	J	A	S	O	N	D
Average maximum temp. °C	31	31	31	31	30	30	29	28	29	29	30	31
Average maximum temp. °C	21	21	21	21	21	21	20	20	20	20	20	20
Rainfall (mm)	51	85	188	158	139	121	134	168	185	221	198	86

If this geographic area were to have a natural forest, which one of the following would it most likely be?

(a) Moist temperate coniferous forest
(b) Montane subtropical forest
(c) Temperate forest
(d) Tropical rain forest

Ans. (d) : The above temperature and rainfall represent tropical rain forest. This geographical region have double rainfall peak, coinciding with March and October and high average annual temperature with only 2-3°C annual temperature range. Total annual average rainfall is 173.4 cm.

Altitude of area is around 400 m, which has little impact for tropical areas because height of 400 m above sea level is largely the height of Plain area.

36. A new type of E1 Nino called E1 Nino Modoki appeared in the news. In this context, consider the following statements:

1. **Normal E1 Nino forms in the Central Pacific ocean whereas E1 Nino Modoki forms in Eastern Pacific ocean.**
2. **Normal E1 Nino results in diminished hurricanes in the Atlantic ocean but E1 Nino Modoki results in a greater number of hurricanes with greater frequency.**

Which of the statements given above is/are correct?

(a) 1 only (b) 2 only
(c) Both 1 and 2 (d) Neither 1 nor 2

Ans. (b) : Normal El Nino results in diminished hurricanes in the Atlantic ocean but El Nino Modoki results in a greater number of hurricanes with greater frequency.

37. Though coffee and tea both are cultivated on hill slopes, there is some difference between them regarding their cultivation. In this context, consider the following statements:

1. **Coffee plant requires a hot and humid climate of tropical areas where as tea can be cultivated in both tropical and subtropical areas.**
2. **Coffee is propagated by seeds but tea is propagated by stem cuttings only.**

Which of the statements given above is/are correct?

(a) 1 only (b) 2 only
(c) Both 1 and 2 (d) Neither 1 nor 2

Ans. (a) : Coffee plant requires a hot and humid climate of tropical areas whereas tea can be cultivated in both tropical and subtropical areas.

INDIAN CONSTITUTION AND POLITY

38. Which one of the following authorities makes recommendation to the Governor of a State as to the principles for determining the taxes and duties which may be appropriated by the Panchayats in that particular State?

(a) District Planning Committees
(b) State Finance Commission
(c) Finance Ministry of that State
(d) Panchayati Raj Ministry of that State

Ans. (b) : State Finance Commission is an institution created by the 73rd and 74th constitutional Amendments (CAs) to rationalize and systematize State /sub-State-level fiscal relations in India. Article 243I of the Constitution mandated the State Governor to constitute a Finance Commission every five years.

39. Consider the following statements:

In India, taxes on transactions in Stock Exchanges and Futures Markets are

1. **levied by the Union**
2. **collected by the State**

Which of the statements given above is/are correct?

(a) 1 only (b) 2 only
(c) Both 1 and 2 (d) Neither 1 nor 2

Ans. (a) : As per Article 269 of the Constitution of India, taxes other than stamp duties on transactions in stock-exchanges and futures markets are levied and collected by the Union but assigned to the states.

40. With reference to the Consumer Disputes Redressal at district level in India. Which one of the following statements is not correct?

(a) A State Government can establish more than one District Forum in a district if it deems fit
(b) One of the members of the District Forum shall be a woman.
(c) The District Forum entertains the Complaints where the value of goods or services does not exceed rupees fifty lakhs.
(d) A complaint in relation to any goods sold or any service provided may be filed with a District Forum by the State Government as a representative of the interests of the consumers in general.

Ans. (c) : As per section 21 of consumer protection act 1986 the District Forum entertains the complaints where the value of goods or services does not exceed rupees twenty lakhs.

41. In the context of governance, consider the following:

1. **Encouraging Foreign Direct Investment inflows**
2. **Privatization of higher educational Institutions**
3. **Down-sizing of bureaucracy**
4. **Selling/offloading the shares of Public Sector Undertakings**

Which of the above can be used as measures to control the fiscal deficit in India?

(a) 1, 2 and 3 (b) 2, 3 and 4
(c) 1, 2 and 4 (d) 3 and 4 only

Ans. (b) : Privatization of higher educational Institutions and down-sizing of bureaucracy and selling/ offloading the shares of Public Sector Undertakings directly cause reduction in fiscal deficit.

Without knowing the destination of Foreign Direct Investment inflows, we cannot determine the actual effect of it on fiscal situation.